In 1972, when China found itself in the position that India was in 1949, on the question of according recognition to the new nation of Bangladesh, Zhou had this to say to American President Richard Nixon: 'We will probably recognize Bangladesh later on. Perhaps we will be the last one. Our reasons for that have to do with two questions. The first is the withdrawal of troops from both East and West Pakistan. The second thing is, it would not do for them (India) to proclaim that the problem of Kashmir is already settled because the UN hasn't agreed and we still have observers there.' [37] China did not allow the clock to put pressure on them, nor did they shy away from articulating their expectations from not just Bangladesh but also from India.

One question remains to be answered. Why did China not raise the Tibet issue with India? It was very much a core Chinese concern in 1949. Possibly, their first priority may have been to secure their south-western border in anticipation of American hostility, and to sever India's ties with the Americans so that they could not use India to contain China. Since the Chinese did not physically control Tibet in 1949, they might also have felt that they did not have a strong enough hand at that point in time with which to negotiate on the matter with India.